

M01 MENTAL HEALTH PROMOTION | P

Intent : Promote mental health and well-being through the provision of supportive programs, policies and resources.

Summary : This WELL feature requires projects to provide programs, policies and resources that support and promote occupant mental health.

Issue : Recent estimates indicate that common mental health conditions (e.g., anxiety, depression, substance use) are experienced by 18% of adults over a 12-month period, and 30% of adults over their lifetime.¹ Depression is the leading cause of disability in the world, and depression and anxiety alone cost the global economy an estimated \$1 trillion due to lost productivity, yet global annual spending on mental health is less than \$2 per person.^{2,3} Failure to address mental health in the workplace can contribute to high turnover, presenteeism and absenteeism, repetitive recruitment and training costs, increased use of drug plans, disability claims, sick leave, employee assistance plans (EAPs) and other costly supports, increased accidents and injuries, and burnout.⁴⁻⁶

Solutions : Given the high prevalence of mental health conditions among the working population, the workplace is an important target for promotion, prevention and intervention efforts.^{7,8} Strategies include increased organizational support, enhancement of mental health literacy and reduction of stigma, which have been shown to help people recognize signs of poor mental health and encourage help-seeking behavior.^{8,9} Improving opportunities for restoration through mindfulness programming and optimal sleep can have a marked impact on mental well-being, including relief from negative symptoms associated with anxiety, depression, pain and stress, as well as enhancements in overall perceived health.¹⁰⁻¹³

PART 1 PROMOTE MENTAL HEALTH AND WELL-BEING

For All Spaces:

The following requirements are met:

- a. At least two of the following are available to all employees and students at no additional cost:
 1. Education or awareness efforts on mental health and well-being, offered quarterly, either in-person or virtually (e.g., webcast on stress management, presentation on mindfulness, email on healthy sleep habits).^{14,15}
 2. Trainings or courses related to mental health and well-being, offered annually, either in-person or virtually (e.g., Mental Health First Aid, stress management training).^{14,15}
 3. Mindfulness or restorative programming, offered weekly, either in-person or virtually (e.g., ongoing access to guided meditation application, weekly yoga classes).⁷
 4. Policy that establishes healthy working hours, outlining the maximum hours to be worked per 24-hour and seven-day period.¹⁶
 5. Dedicated space for restoration and relaxation, with an accompanying policy permitting breaks during work or school hours.^{16,17}
- b. Annual communication (e.g., email, online module, in-person training) is provided to all employees and students, and onboarding communications are provided to all new employees and students, specifically addressing all mental health and well-being benefits, resources and programs available through the project or organization.

Note : Projects may achieve points in optimizations that overlap with strategies listed in Part 1.a.

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